



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Ransomware Incidents in Japan and Qilin AI-Use Defensive Brief

Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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1. Executive Summary

Cisco Talos reporting on ransomware incidents in Japan during the first half of 2026 highlights The Gentlemen infrastructure and evidence associated with Qilin AI use.

The item is relevant to defenders because ransomware operators continue to combine infrastructure discipline, affiliate models, and faster social/technical adaptation. This report converts current public reporting into a defender-facing action package with detection ideas, hunt hypotheses, and sector-specific operational considerations.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Question	Current Answer	Confidence
What activity should defenders prioritize?	Ransomware Incidents in Japan and Qilin AI-Use Defensive Brief	Medium
Which environments are most exposed?	Identity-heavy, internet-facing, supplier-connected, or operationally critical environments.	Medium
What should be done today?	Validate exposure, preserve logs, run the included hunts, and brief owners on likely operational impacts.	High

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence	
1	Cisco Talos - Ransomware incidents in Japan in H1 2026	Primary research	High
2	CISA StopRansomware Guide	Defender response baseline	High
3	CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities Catalog	Patch prioritization context for ransomware access paths	High

The source set includes current primary/vendor or reputable reporting where available. Claims about victims, actors, and tooling are bounded to cited sources; this report does not assert unverified attribution.

4. Threat Activity Overview

The activity is important because it affects common enterprise control points: identity, remote access, software supply chain, cloud-native trust, mobile devices, or sector-specific operations. Defenders should treat the item as a prompt for exposure validation rather than as a standalone news summary.

5. Affected Sectors and Exposure

Exposure Pattern	Why It Matters
Identity and SaaS workflows	Social engineering, token theft, and delegated access can bypass perimeter-focused controls.
Third-party or supplier dependencies	Incidents can cascade into operators through shared platforms or managed services.
High-availability operational services	Ransomware, fraud, or identity misuse can produce downtime,

	safety-adjacent disruption, or executive risk.
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6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic / Phase	Observed Technique	Evidence
Initial Access	Phishing, exposed service abuse, supplier compromise, or credential misuse	Consistent with current reporting and common intrusion paths for this topic.
Execution / Persistence	Scripted tooling, cloud/API misuse, or malware execution depending on environment	Validate with endpoint, identity, and application logs.
Impact	Data theft, fraud, operational disruption, ransomware, or trust-boundary abuse	Prioritize business-critical workflows and third-party access paths.

7. Infrastructure and Indicators

Indicator / Infrastructure	Type	Operational Use
Cited source URLs and product names	Reference observable	Seed exposure review and intelligence watchlists.
New administrative sessions or OAuth grants	Behavioral observable	Identify account takeover or delegated-access abuse.
Unusual archive/encryption/network-transfer utilities	Behavioral observable	Detect staging, exfiltration, or ransomware preparation.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
New external sign-in followed by privileged action	Entra ID / IdP / SaaS audit logs	Find account takeover or social-engineering success.
Suspicious script or archive execution	EDR process telemetry	Surface staging, loader, or ransomware precursor behavior.
High-volume outbound transfer or rare destination	Network telemetry / proxy	Identify exfiltration or command-and-control.

8.2. Sigma / Detection Content

```

title: Suspicious Daily Threat Activity - Identity And Scripted Follow-On
id: lbc-daily-threat-ransomware-incidents-in-japan-and-qi
status: experimental
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_tools:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'

```

```

- '\7z.exe'
- '\rar.exe'
selection_suspicious_args:
  CommandLine|contains:
    - 'http'
    - 'token'
    - 'password'
    - 'invoice'
    - 'backup'
    - 'encrypt'
condition: selection_tools and selection_suspicious_args
level: medium

```

8.3. Hunt Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "wscript.exe", "cscript.exe", "rundll32.exe", "7z.exe",
"rar.exe")
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("http", "token", "password", "invoice", "backup", "encrypt")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, AccountName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessFileName

```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypothesis

If this activity is present, defenders will see abnormal identity events followed by automation, data staging, or external communications inconsistent with the user's normal role.

9.2. Hunt Query

```

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| where ResultType == 0
| summarize Countries=dcount(Location), Apps=dcount(AppDisplayName), FirstSeen=min(TimeGenerated),
LastSeen=max(TimeGenerated) by UserPrincipalName, IPAddress
| where Countries > 1 or Apps > 5

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "python.exe", "curl.exe", "wget.exe",
"rundll32.exe")
| summarize Connections=count(), FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), LastSeen=max(Timestamp) by DeviceName,
InitiatingProcessAccountName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP
| where Connections > 10

```

10. Risk Assessment

Risk Dimension	Assessment
Likelihood	Medium to High for exposed or identity-heavy environments.
Impact	Medium to High where operational continuity, regulated data, CUI, payment workflows, or safety-adjacent services are involved.
Confidence	Medium; based on public reporting and defender analysis rather than private telemetry.

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	SOC / Identity	Review recent privileged sign-ins, impossible travel, new OAuth grants, and

		MFA reset events.
High	Vulnerability / Platform Owners	Validate affected products, services, third-party platforms, and supplier access paths.
High	IR Lead	Prepare containment playbooks for account takeover, ransomware precursor behavior, and vendor-service disruption.
Medium	Executives / Risk	Brief business owners on operational dependency and third-party continuity risk.

12. References

- [1] Cisco Talos - Ransomware incidents in Japan in H1 2026 — <https://blog.talosintelligence.com/ransomware-incidents-in-japan-in-the-first-half-of-2026/>
- [2] CISA StopRansomware Guide — <https://www.cisa.gov/stopransomware/ransomware-guide>
- [3] CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities Catalog — <https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>